



I Want To Be Entertained...

...that's what comes to us first when we look at technology for leisure. Let's take a look at some products out there that will guarantee a smile for you and the family

Robert Sovereign-Smith

Our homes are becoming more digitised—which will be obvious after you're done counting the number of gadgets in your house. But that's not the end of it—you probably already wish you had newer models of most of them! That's the lifestyle we're getting used to today, and will continue to do so. This willingness to spend has raised the bar for manufacturers, and with technology surging ahead and convergence blurring the lines between product categories, it's no surprise that every device you go out to buy has a spec sheet over two pages long!

Manufacturers are falling over themselves in the race to your home, offering gadgets in almost every form. However, the most significant category, which is also the most hotly contested, is the personal entertainment segment. Let's skip past the air conditioner that can be switched on remotely, and the fridge that has an inbuilt 12-inch TVs, and look at some products that do nothing but entertain.

TVs

Traditionally, the idiot box has been a staple of everyone's fun diet, and still is. Only, now the boxes are a lot smarter, and come in huge sizes, with as many features as there are competing brands.

The television was given a huge boost in popularity—not that it

needed one—with the coming of cable TV in India over a decade ago. Now, with more channels than we care to remember, and a more informed target audience, TVs really need to keep up with ever-changing technologies. Since this is the era of high definition (HD) video, the TV segment is leading the way, and almost every manufacturer has already released products that are decently future-proofed in terms of technology.

It's the age of plasma and LCD TVs, and almost every manufacturer is offering various models of these. What's really cool right now are wireless TVs that do away with the clutter of cables—be it the cable that comes in through the window, those that emanate from your DVD player, and so on. So when you're thinking about where to place your TV, all you need to keep an eye open for is a power outlet. Of course, if you want to, you can have a portable TV for yourself, which doesn't even need a power outlet—for a few hours of viewing at least!

Sharp AQUOS LC-15L1U-S

Sharp's wireless AQUOS LC-15L1U-S is an LCD television that offers 15 inches of screen space (4:3 aspect ratio) and is less than 3 inches deep. It has a rechargeable battery, a 500:1 contrast ratio and a great viewing angle of 170 degrees. It can be carried up to 50 feet from the base station, and why would you want any more than that? With just 2 x 2.1 watt speakers, it's not something you'll enjoy watching a rock concert on, but hey, catching up with the news while you're in the loo should be cool enough to want one! Approximately Rs 50,000 is what